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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

US: Israel accepts ceasefire proposal

Hamas reviews deal; Israel plans to add West Bank settlements

By Julia Frankel and Natalie Melzer
Associated Press

JERUSALEM — The White House said Thursday that Israel has accepted a new U.S. proposal for a temporary ceasefire with Hamas.

In a statement, Hamas said it has received the proposal and “is reviewing it responsibly to serve the interests of our people, provide them relief, and achieve a permanent ceasefire in the Gaza Strip.”

Earlier Thursday, however, Israel said it would establish 22 more Jewish settlements in the occupied West Bank, including the legalization of outposts already built without government authorization. And in the Gaza Strip, Israeli strikes killed at least 34 people, local health officials said.

It was not immediately clear how Israel’s expansion announcement would affect a potential ceasefire in Gaza, or any efforts to establish a longer peace agreement.

Israel captured the West Bank, along with Gaza and east Jerusalem, in the 1967 Mideast war and the Palestinians want all three territories for their future state. Most of the international community views settlements as illegal and an obstacle to resolving the decades-old conflict.

The fresh signs of progress toward a temporary truce came after President Donald Trump’s special envoy, Steve Witkoff, expressed optimism earlier this week about brokering an agreement to halt the Israel-Hamas war and return more of the hostages captured in the attack that ignited it.

White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said Israel “backed and supported” the new proposal.

Hamas had previously said it

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INSIDE

Separate rulings scramble trade war

A federal appeals court Thursday temporarily agreed to preserve many of the president’s tariffs, pausing an earlier decision by a separate court. **Nation & World**

Intuit Art Museum has big reopening

The West Town institution that has collected work by self-taught artists rings in a new chapter. “I don’t want this to be a traditional art museum,” the director said. **A+E**

ILLINOIS LEGISLATURE



Members of the Senate Transportation Committee, including state Sen. Darby Hills, center, talk before meeting on the Northern Illinois Transit Authority Act, which would replace the Regional Transportation Authority, at the state Capitol on Thursday in Springfield. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**

Transit proposal would hike tolls, tax ride-shares

After months of negotiations, lawmakers introduce bill to avoid \$771M fiscal cliff

By Talia Soglin, Olivia Olander and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — After months of negotiations amid warnings of potentially drastic service cuts, Illinois lawmakers on Wednesday introduced a bill they said addresses the expected \$771 million financial shortfall for Chicago-area public transit with proposals that include a 50-cent hike on Illinois toll roads and an additional tax on ride-sharing services.

“The funding mechanism we put forward, with estimates, gets us above the fiscal cliff amount,” Democratic Sen. Ram Villivalam of Chicago, chair of the committee covering transportation, said Thursday. “The goal is to ensure that we’re funding a system not for tomorrow, not for next year but for decades to come.”

Key labor organizations were quick to question this Senate proposal, citing concerns over the long-term viability of the funding streams. Also voicing opposition were suburban officials who said this bill and a

similar one in the House put the interests of mass transit users, most of them in Chicago, above those of their constituents.

Transit agencies have said services would be slashed if legislators don’t come up with funding to plug the budget shortfall expected when COVID-19 relief funding runs out at the end of this year. With the spring legislative session set to end this weekend, agencies have said they will need to start planning for those cuts soon, though lawmakers could take up the issue to later in the year.

The push to address mass transit funding comes as lawmakers also face a Saturday deadline to approve a spending plan for the budget year that begins July 1. Key Democratic legislators and representatives from Gov. JB Pritzker’s office continued to hash out what’s expected to be a roughly \$55 billion plan behind closed doors Thursday, a day after the governor vowed to veto any plan that relies on “broad-based” taxes to come into balance.

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House OKs bill banning fines for infractions at school

Legislation would end practice that harmed students across state

By Jodi S. Cohen and Jennifer Smith Richards
ProPublica

Illinois legislators on Wednesday passed a bill to explicitly prevent police from ticketing and fining students for minor misbehavior at school, ending a practice that harmed students across the state.

The measure would apply to all public schools, including charters. It will require school districts, beginning in the 2027-28 school year, to report to the state how often they involve police in student matters each year and to separate the data by race, gender and disability. The state will be required to make the data public.

The legislation comes three years after a ProPublica and Chicago Tribune investigation, “The Price Kids Pay,” revealed that even though Illinois law

bans school officials from fining students directly, districts skirted the law by calling on police to issue citations for violating local ordinances.

“The Price Kids Pay” found that thousands of Illinois students had been ticketed in recent years for adolescent behavior once handled by the principal’s office — things such as littering, making loud noises, swearing, fighting or vaping in the bathroom. It also found that Black students were twice as likely to be ticketed at school than

their white peers.

From the House floor, Rep. La Shawn Ford, a Democrat from Chicago, thanked the news organizations for exposing the practice and told legislators that the goal of the bill “is to make sure if there is a violation of school code, the school should use their discipline policies” rather than disciplining students through police-issued tickets.

State Sen. Karina Villa, a Democrat from suburban West

Turn to Law, Page 4



Larry Hoover, in prison since 1973, faces the parole board with his wife, Winndye Jenkins, at Dixon Correctional Center on Feb. 7, 1995. **JOHN DZIEKAN/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Chicago FBI boss: Hoover ‘deserves to be in prison’

Lawyers for Gangster Disciples’ founder praise Trump’s move

By Jason Meisner and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

A day after Donald Trump’s stunning decision to commute the federal life sentence of Larry Hoover, lawyers for the Chicago-born Gangster Disciples founder were singing the president’s praises while Chicago’s new FBI boss told the Tribune that Hoover “deserves to be in prison.” Trump abruptly ended Hoover’s

long quest to win early release under the First Step Act by granting a full commutation of his sentence Wednesday afternoon, directing the U.S. Bureau of Prisons to release him “immediately,” according to a copy of the document provided by Hoover’s legal team.

But Hoover is still serving a 200-year sentence for his state court conviction for murder, making him likely to stay behind bars — at least for the time being.

“The President of the United States has the authority to pardon whoever he wishes,” FBI Special

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TODAY’S WEATHER



High 80 Low 51

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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